



# How to Communicate Effectively on LinkedIn

Ensure your messages, comments, and updates stand out from the crowd.



# 1

## Be authentic.

Communicate on LinkedIn the same way you would in professional interactions outside of LinkedIn. No need to be overly formal or change your style – be real, be you, but be professional.

# 2

## Customize your connection requests.

Instead of using the generic “I’d like to add you to my professional network on LinkedIn” message, tailor each request. Remind him/her where you met or explain why you want to connect. They’ll be more likely to respond.



# 3

## Be responsive.

Reply within a few days to connection requests, personal messages, or comments on group discussions you post. Stay on top of your LinkedIn inbox! This will keep you top-of-mind with people and opportunities.

# 4

## Research before reaching out.

Review a person’s profile before contacting him/her on LinkedIn. You’ll make a stronger connection by highlighting things you have in common or specific aspects of his/her experience you want to discuss.



# 5

## Be targeted and personalized.

Stay away from stuff like, “Hi everyone – I’m sorry for the mass message!” Your connections are more likely to respond to personalized messages. If you do want to announce something in a mass way, use a status update instead.

6

**Be careful with introductions.**

If you're asked for an introduction to someone in your network, remember that your reputation is on the line. Unless you're confident in recommending someone or you know the connection well, it's okay to politely refuse.



7

**Keep it short and sweet.**

In today's busy world, no one wants to read long, dense paragraphs on their computer or smartphone. Keep your profile summary, messages, group discussion postings, and recommendations clear and to the point.



8

**Proofread.**

Remember that everything you post on LinkedIn could be seen by a wide audience (even private messages could be forwarded or saved). Represent yourself well by double-checking spelling, grammar, style, and tone.

9

**Give more than you take.**

Balance your needs on LinkedIn with those of your connections. In addition to updating your own status and asking for help or connections, try commenting on other people's updates and helping with their requests.



10

**Always say thank you.**

When someone answers a question you've posted, provides an introduction, suggests a job, or otherwise helps you on LinkedIn, send him/her a thank you message. The golden rule applies online just as much as it does in person.


**LinkedIn**™

# Communicate on LinkedIn.

Get going at [www.linkedin.com](http://www.linkedin.com)

Copyright © 2013 LinkedIn Corporation. LinkedIn and the LinkedIn logo are registered trademarks of LinkedIn Corporation in the United States and/or other countries. All rights reserved.



## Career Exploration Sample In Mail Template

Hello Melodye Goldsmith,

I'm majoring in Finance and heading into my junior year. While browsing leading financial companies on LinkedIn, your profile came up. I am interested in learning more about your role (and am especially interested in...)(*insert your preferences here*).

Would you have 20 minutes in the next week to meet over zoom or by phone to share more details about your career path? I'd love to hear how you got into (*insert your preference here*) and your challenges and successes.

Looking forward to hearing your insights!

Thank you,

Elias Shapiro

## Expanding Your Network 1 Sample In Mail Template

Hello John Horowitz,

Would you mind sharing your expertise regarding your work experience? The work you are involved with closely aligns with my goals and interest. Do you have a few minutes next week to meet over zoom or by phone to share more details about your work and career trajectory? I'd love to learn how you got to where you are today. Please let me know best times for a conversation.

Looking forward,

Emily Rose

## Expanding Your Network 2 Sample In Mail Template

Hello Susan Steinberg,

I was intrigued when your profile popped up just now while researching connections/companies.

I'm a class of 2019 Syms/Stern/Yeshiva College grad and I'd love to connect with fellow alumni. Would you be willing to share more about your career path since leaving YU? I'd love to connect even if just for 20 minutes via zoom or phone in the next week or so.

Looking forward,

Sam Cook

### Career Exploration Connection Note

300 word count limit

Hello Melodye Goldsmith,

While browsing leading financial companies on LinkedIn, your profile came up. I am interested in learning more about your role. I'm majoring in Finance and heading into my junior year. Would you have time to share more details about your career path? I'd love to hear how you got into (x).

Thank you,

Elias Shapiro

### Expanding Your Network Note

300 word count limit

Hello Susan Steinberg,

I was intrigued when your profile popped up just now while researching connections. I'm a class of 2019 (X) grad and I'd love to connect with fellow alumni. Would you be willing to share more about your career path since leaving YU? I'd love to connect via zoom or phone at a mutually convenient time.

Thank you,

Sam Cook

Hello John Horowitz,

Would you mind sharing your expertise regarding your work experience? The work you are involved with closely aligns with my goals and interest. Do you have a few minutes to share more details about your work and career trajectory? Please let me know your best times for a conversation.

Thank you,

Emily Rose

